INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-3933F
7 November 2002
SUPERSEDING
MIL-A-3933E
24 April 1985

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

ATTENUATORS, FIXED
GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for radio and microwave frequency fixed attenuators (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

MIL-DTL-85	-	Waveguides, Rigid, Rectangular, General Specification for.
MIL-L-3890	-	Lines, Radio Frequency Transmission (Coaxial, Air Dielectric), General Specification for.
MIL-DTL-3922	-	Flanges, Waveguide, General Purpose, General Specification for.
MIL-H-28719	-	Headers-Hermetically Sealed.
MIL-PRF-39012	-	Connectors, Coaxial, Radio Frequency, General Specification for.
MIL-C-55302	-	Connectors, Printed Circuit Subassembly and Accessories.

(See supplement 1 for list of associated specification sheets.)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and data of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Supply Center, Columbus, ATTN: DSCC-VAT, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43216-5000, using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) herein or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 5985
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595	-	Colors Used in Government Procurement.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

MIL-STD-129	-	Standard Practice for Military Marking.
MIL-STD-130	-	Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-202	-	Test Method Standard Electronic and Electrical Component Parts.
MIL-STD-889	-	Dissimilar Metals.
MIL-STD-1276	-	Leads for Electronic Component Parts.
MIL-STD-2073-1	-	Standard Practice for Military Packaging.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of the above specifications, standards, and drawings are available from the Defense Automation and Production Service, Building 4D (DPM-DODSSP), 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following document(s) form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI-Z540.1	-	Calibration Laboratories and Measuring and Test Equipment (DoD adopted).

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 25 West 43rd Street, New York, NY 10036.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM-B16/B16M	-	Free Cutting Brass Rod, Bar, Shapes, For Use in Screw Machines (DoD adopted - replaces ASTM B16M).
ASTM-B36/B36M	-	Brass Plate, Sheet, Strip, and Rolled Bar (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B121/B121M	-	Leaded Brass Plate, Sheet, Strip, and Rolled Bar (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B124/B124M	-	Copper and Copper Alloy Forging Rod, Bar, and Shapes.
ASTM-B194	-	Copper-Beryllium Alloy Plate, Sheet, Strip, and Rolled Bar (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B196/B196M	-	Copper-Beryllium Alloy Rod and Bar (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B197/B197M	-	Copper-Beryllium Alloy Wire (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B488	-	Electrodeposited Coatings of Gold for Engineering Uses (DoD adopted).
ASTM-A582/A582M	-	Free-Machining Stainless Steel Bars (DoD adopted).
ASTM-B700	-	Electrodeposited Coatings of Silver for Engineering.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM), 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTITUTE OF ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONICS ENGINEERS (IEEE)

IEEE-STD-287	-	Precision Coax Connectors.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers, IEEE Service Center, 445 Hoes Lane, P. O. Box 1331, Piscataway, NJ 08855-1331.)

INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION FOR STANDARDIZATION (ISO)

ISO10012-1	-	Quality Assurance Requirements for Measuring Equipment, Part 1: Metrological Conformation System for Measuring Equipment (DoD adopted).

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 11 West 42nd Street, New York, NY 10036-0350.)

SOCIETY OF AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERS (SAE)

SAE-AMS-QQ-S-763	-	Steel Bars, Wire, Shapes, and Forgings; Corrosion Resistant (DoD adopted).
SAE-AMS2422	-	Plating, Gold.
SAE-AMS4375	-	Sheet and Plate, Magnesium Alloy (3.0 Al - 1.0 Zn - 0.20 Mn) (AZ31B-0) Annealed and Recrystallized (DoD adopted).
SAE-AMS4376	-	Plate, Magnesium Alloy (3.0 Al - 1.0 Zn - 0.20 Mn (AZ31B-H26)), Cold Rolled and Partially Annealed (DoD adopted).
SAE-AMS4377	-	Sheet and Plate, Magnesium Alloy (3.0 Al - 1.0 Zn - 0.20 Mn) (AZ31B-H24), Cold Rolled, Partially Annealed (DoD adopted).

(Applications for copies should be addressed to Society of Automotive Engineers, Inc., 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated specifications, specification sheets, or MS sheets), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets. In the event of any conflict between requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Qualification. Attenuators furnished under this specification shall be products which are qualified for listing on the applicable qualified products list at the time set for opening of bids (see 4.5 and 6.3).

3.3 Material. The material shall be as specified herein and in the applicable specification sheets. When a definite material is not specified, a material shall be used which will enable the attenuator to meet the performance requirements of this specification. Acceptance or approval of any constituent material shall not be construed as a guaranty of the acceptance of the finished product.

3.3.1 Brass. Brass shall conform to ASTM-B16/B16M, ASTM-B36/B36M, ASTM-B121/B121M, ASTM-B124/B124M.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.2 Copper alloy. Copper alloy used in fabrication of waveguide-type attenuators shall conform to the requirements for copper alloy specified in MIL-DTL-85. Copper alloy used in the fabrication of coaxial-type attenuators shall conform to the material requirements specified in MIL-L-3890.

3.3.3 Copper-beryllium. When specified, copper-beryllium alloy shall conform to ASTM-B194, ASTM-B196/B196M, or ASTM-B197/B197M.

3.3.4 Aluminum alloy. Aluminum alloy used in the fabrication of waveguide-type attenuators shall conform to the requirements for aluminum alloy specified in MIL-DTL-85.

3.3.5 Magnesium alloy. Magnesium alloy shall be composition AZ31B, condition H24, conforming to SAE-AMS-4375, SAE-AMS-4376, and SAE-AMS-4377. When specified (see 3.1 and 6.2), magnesium attenuators shall be supplied.

3.3.6 Dissimilar metals. Unless suitably protected against electrolytic corrosion, dissimilar metals (see MIL-STD-889) shall not be used in intimate contact with each other. Dissimilar metals are defined as metal specimens that are in contact or otherwise electrically connected to each other in a conductive solution and that generate an electric current.

3.4 Design and construction. Attenuators shall be of the design, construction, and physical dimensions specified (see 3.1). Attenuators shall be of the lightest practicable weight consistent with the strength required for sturdiness, safety, and reliability.

3.4.1 Operating frequency range. The frequency range shall be as specified.

3.4.2 Nominal impedance. The nominal impedance for attenuators shall be as specified.

3.4.3 Flange. Flanges shall be so designed and manufactured as to provide the mating characteristics of the flange specified in accordance with MIL-DTL-3922.

3.4.4 Connectors. The connectors shall be as specified (see 3.1). The material and gauging for receptacle socket contact (female) and for pin contact (male) connectors shall conform to the requirements of MIL-PRF-39012. Male connectors shall meet the coupling proof torque, contact push, contact retention and rotational contact retention requirements. Female connectors shall meet requirements for engaging/disengaging forces, contact retention and rotational contact retention. When specified (see 3.1), precision connectors shall be in accordance with IEEE-STD-287.

3.4.4.1 Connector metal parts. Unless otherwise specified, the male center contact pins shall be captivated and made of corrosion resisting steel, type 302 or 304 in accordance with SAE-AMS-QQ-S-763, type 303 in accordance with ASTM-A582/A582M or beryllium copper, or equivalent * material, conforming to ASTM-B194, ASTM-B196/B196M, or ASTM-B197/B197M. Beryllium copper, or equivalent * material, parts shall be gold plated in accordance with SAE-AMS2422 and/or ASTM-B488 over a nickel plate. Stainless steel parts shall be silver plated in accordance with ASTM B700, Type II, Grade A or gold plated in accordance with SAE-AMS2422. The female center contact pins shall be captivated and made of beryllium copper, or equivalent * material, conforming to ASTM-B194, ASTM-B196/B196M, or ASTM-B197/B197M and when specified (see 3.1), gold plated in accordance with SAE-AMS2422 and/or ASTM-B488 with 99.7 percent gold minimum, Knoop hardness 130 - 300, inclusive, 0.00005 inch minimum gold thickness over a nickel plate. Nickel is used only when specifications cannot be met using alternate material means. (* Equivalent material is that which meets all the required electrical, mechanical and environmental requirements of the male or female center contact pins.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.4.2 Printed circuit connectors. Printed circuit connectors for a specific attenuator shall conform to MIL-C-55302.

3.4.5 Leads. Leads connections for a specific attenuator shall be a chemical composition conforming to MIL-STD-1276 and shall be solderable unless otherwise specified.

3.4.6 Socket pins. Socket pins for a specific attenuator shall conform to MIL-H-28719 as applicable.

3.4.7 Weight. The weight for attenuators shall be as specified (see 3.1).

3.4.8 External finish. The external finish of attenuators shall be as specified (see 3.1).

3.4.9 Temperature range. Operating/non-operating temperature range shall be as specified (see 3.1).

3.5 Performance.

3.5.1 Screening. All screened attenuators produced by this specification shall be screened in accordance with table I. After screening, the attenuator shall be subjected to and pass group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3). Screening requirements shall consist of 3.5.1.1 through 3.5.1.7:

3.5.1.1 Thermal shock. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.1. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.1, they shall be subjected to and pass Group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3).

3.5.1.2 Conditioning. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.2. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.2, they shall be subjected to and pass Group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3).

3.5.1.3 Visual and mechanical examination. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.3. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.3, they shall be subjected to and pass Group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3).

3.5.1.4 Pre-burn-in electrical. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.4. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.4, they shall be subjected to and pass Group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3).

3.5.1.5 Burn-in. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.5. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.5, they shall be subjected to and pass Group A inspection (see 4.6.1.3).

3.5.1.6 Post burn-in electrical. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.6. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.6, they shall pass the delta limit criteria of 4.7.2.6.

3.5.1.7 Radiographic. Screen attenuators in accordance with 4.7.2.7. After attenuators are screened in accordance with 4.7.2.7, they shall satisfy all detail criteria listed in 4.7.2.7.

3.5.2 Coaxial connector wear resistance. When attenuators with coaxial connectors are tested as specified in 4.7.3, there shall be no damage to the connectors that will cause electrical failure. During and after cycling, neither lubrication nor removal of excess material shall be permitted. After this test, attenuators shall meet the requirements of 3.5.3 and 3.5.4.

3.5.3 Voltage standing wave ratio (VSWR) (at either end). When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.4, the VSWR at room temperature shall not exceed the value specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.4 Attenuation. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.5, the attenuation at room temperature shall be as specified. The deviation from nominal value shall not exceed the applicable value in the specification sheet.

3.5.5 Electromagnetic interference (RF leakage) (for coaxial and waveguide attenuators). When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.6, the RF leakage from the attenuator shall be at least 65 dB below the incoming signal level.

3.5.6 Coaxial connector repeatability. After attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.7, the variation of attenuation shall not exceed the applicable value in the specification sheet.

3.5.7 Solderability (as applicable). When attenuators with solderable connections are tested as specified in 4.7.8, there shall be no evidence of pinholes and blistering.

TABLE I. Screening.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Thermal shock	3.5.1.1	4.7.2.1
Conditioning	3.5.1.2	4.7.2.2
Visual and mechanical examination	3.5.1.3	4.7.2.3
Pre-burn-in electrical:	3.5.1.4	4.7.2.4
DC resistance 1/	3.5.1.4	4.7.2.4.1
VSWR	3.5.1.4, 3.5.3	4.7.2.4.2, 4.7.4
Attenuation	3.5.1.4, 3.5.4	4.7.2.4.3, 4.7.5
Burn-in 240 hours	3.5.1.5	4.7.2.5
Post-burn-in electrical:	3.5.1.6	4.7.2.6
DC resistance 1/	3.5.1.6	4.7.2.6
VSWR	3.5.1.6	4.7.2.6
Attenuation	3.5.1.6	4.7.2.6
Radiographic inspection	3.5.1.7	4.7.2.7

1/ Not applicable for waveguide attenuators.

3.5.8 Terminal strength/lead integrity (as applicable). When attenuators with terminals or leads are tested as specified in 4.7.9, there shall be no evidence of a broken terminal or lead, elongation greater than one-half of the thread pitch, or breakage, loosening, or relative motion between the terminals and the attenuator body when viewed through a magnification of at least 10X. Any of these shall be a failure.

3.5.9 Resistance to solvents. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.10, there shall be no evidence of illegible marking, mechanical damage, or deterioration of material or finishes to the extent that they can be readily identified from a distance of at least six inches with normal room lighting and without the aid of magnification or with a viewer having a magnification no greater than 3X.

3.5.10 Stability of attenuation. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.11, the attenuation change after temperature change, thermal shock, vibration, shock, moisture resistance, salt spray or peak power shall not exceed the applicable value specified in the specification sheet. After the salt spray test, there shall be no evidence of corrosion or pitting.

3.5.11 Sensitivity of attenuation. When computed as specified in 4.7.12, the sensitivity of attenuation of attenuators with frequency, with power, and with temperature shall not exceed the maximum sensitivity of attenuation specified in the appropriate specification sheet.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.12 Life. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.13, the attenuation change shall not exceed the value that was measured for temperature stability under 3.5.4.

3.5.13 Force to engage/disengage. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.14, they shall meet the requirements for Attenuation (see 3.5.4).

3.5.14 Coupling proof torque. When attenuators are tested as specified in 4.7.15, they shall meet the requirements for Attenuation (see 3.5.4).

3.6 Marking. Attenuators shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130, with the class, military PIN, manufacturer's source code or logo, attenuation in dB, frequency range, average power rating, date code, and serialization. When the available marking space is less than 0.15 square inches, the class, attenuation, frequency range, and average power rating may be deleted from the marking. The marking characters shall be at least .031 inch (0.79 mm) high. The marking shall be placed on the attenuator using a method providing legible and permanent marking for the life of the attenuator. The marking location is optional. Marking locations indicated in individual slash sheets are suggested locations. When practicable, a location shall be picked that will be least likely to be covered in attenuator installation.

3.6.1 Date code. Attenuators shall be marked by a unique code to identify the period during which they were manufactured. The first two numbers in the code shall be two digits of the number of the year, and the third and fourth number shall be two digits indicating the calendar week of the year. When the number of the week is a single digit, it shall be proceeded by a zero reading from left to right or from top to bottom, the code number shall designate the year and week, in that order. The date code shall not be altered or removed from the attenuator.

3.6.2 Serialization. Each attenuator shall be marked with a unique serial number assigned consecutively within the inspection lot allowing traceability of the attenuator.

3.7 Workmanship. Attenuators shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from sharp edges and burrs, except where sharp edges are required for mechanical or electrical reasons.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Test equipment and inspection facilities. Test and measuring equipment and inspection facilities of sufficient accuracy, quality, and quantity to permit performance of the required inspection shall be established and maintained by the contractor. The establishment and maintenance of a calibration system to control the accuracy of the measuring and test equipment shall be in accordance with ANSI-Z540.1 and/or ISO10012-1.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Material inspection (see 4.3).

b. Qualification inspection (see 4.5).

c. Conformance inspection (see 4.6).

4.3 Materials inspection. Materials inspection shall consist of certification supported by verifying data that the materials listed in table II, used in fabricating the attenuator, are in accordance with the applicable referenced specifications or requirements prior to such fabrication.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Materials inspection.

Material	Requirement paragraph	Applicable specification
Brass	3.3.1	ASTM-B16/B16M, ASTM-B36/B36M, ASTM-B121/B121M, ASTM-B124/B124M
Copper alloy	3.3.2	MIL-DTL-85, MIL-L-3890
Copper-beryllium	3.3.3	ASTM-B194, ASTM-B196/B196M, ASTM-B197/B197M
Aluminum alloy	3.3.4	MIL-DTL-85
Magnesium alloy	3.3.5	SAE-AMS4375, SAE-AMS4376, SAE-AMS4377

4.4 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified herein, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in the “GENERAL REQUIREMENTS” of MIL-STD-202.

4.4.1 Test method variation. Variation from the specified test methods used to verify the electrical parameters is allowed provided that it is demonstrated to the preparing activity or their agent that such variations in no way relax the requirements of this specification and that they are approved before testing is performed. For proposed test variations, a test method comparative error analysis shall be made available for checking by the preparing activity or their agent.

4.5 Qualification inspection. Qualification inspection shall be performed at a laboratory acceptable to the Government (see 6.3) on sample units produced with equipment and procedures normally used in production. Qualification obtained for each group (see appendix) shall constitute qualification for all attenuators with characteristics for that group (see table III).

TABLE III. Qualification inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Group I (all samples)		
Screened in accordance with table I (for screened attenuators only)	3.5.1	4.7.2
Visual and mechanical examination 1/	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, and 3.7	4.7.1
Coaxial connector wear resistance: 2/	3.5.2	4.7.3
VSWR	3.5.3	4.7.4
Attenuation	3.5.4	4.7.5

See footnotes at end of table.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Qualification inspection - Continued.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Group II - 2 sample units		
Stability of attenuation After temperature change After thermal shock After vibration After shock After moisture resistance After salt spray After peak power	3.5.10	4.7.11
Sensitivity of attenuation After change in frequency After change in input power After change in temperature	3.5.11	4.7.12
Visual and mechanical examination	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, 3.7	4.7.1
Group III - 2 sample units		
Electromagnetic interference/ RF leakage 5/	3.5.5	4.7.6
Coaxial connector repeatability: Attenuation 2/	3.5.6 3.5.4	4.7.7 4.7.5
Solderability 3/	3.5.7	4.7.8
Terminal strength/lead integrity 4/	3.5.8	4.7.9
Resistance to solvents	3.5.9	4.7.10
Life: 760 hours Attenuation	3.5.12 3.5.4	4.7.13 4.7.5
Force to engage/disengage	3.5.13	4.7.14
Coupling proof torque	3.5.14	4.7.15
Visual and mechanical examination	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, 3.7	4.7.1

1/ For nonscreened attenuators only.
2/ Coaxial types of attenuator.
3/ Attenuators with solderable leads or terminal.
4/ Attenuators with leads or terminal.
5/ Coaxial and waveguide types of attenuator.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.1 Sample size. Four samples of the same specification sheet (see 3.1) and PIN shall be subjected to qualification inspection.

4.5.2 Inspection routine. The sample shall be subjected to the qualification inspection specified in table III, in the order shown. All units shall be subjected to the inspection of group I. The sample shall then be divided into two groups of two units each (see 4.5.1). The sample units shall then be subjected only to the inspections indicated for their particular group.

4.5.3 Failures. One or more failures shall be cause for refusal to grant qualification approval. A failure shall be anything that does not meet the requirements of the specification.

4.5.4 Disposition of qualification sample units. Sample units which have been subjected to qualification testing shall not be delivered on any contract or purchase order. The Government reserves the right to retain the sample units or to require the contractor to furnish the sample units with the qualification inspection report.

4.5.5 Retention of qualification. To retain qualification, the contractor shall forward a report at 24-month intervals to the qualifying activity (see 6.3). The qualifying activity shall establish the initial reporting date. The report shall consist of:

a. A summary of the results of the tests performed for inspection of product for delivery (group A), indicating as a minimum the number of attenuators that have passed and the number that have failed. The results of the tests of all reworked attenuators shall be identified and accounted for.

b. A summary of the results of tests performed for periodic inspection (group B), including the number and mode of failures. The summary shall include results of all periodic inspection tests performed and completed during the 24-month period. If the summary of test results indicates nonconformance with specification requirements, and corrective action acceptable to the qualifying activity has not been taken, action shall be taken to remove the failing product from the qualified products list.

Failure to submit the report within 60 days after the end of each 24-month period shall result in loss of qualification for the product. In addition to the periodic submission of inspection data, the contractor shall immediately notify the qualifying activity at any time during the 24-month period that the inspection data indicates failure of the qualified product to meet the requirements of this specification.

In the event that no production occurred during the reporting period, a report shall be submitted certifying that the company still has the capabilities and facilities necessary to produce the attenuators. If during the two consecutive reporting periods there has been no production, the manufacturers may be required, at the discretion of the qualifying activity, to submit his qualified products to testing in accordance with the qualification inspection requirements and the reason for no production.

4.6 Conformance inspection.

4.6.1 General. Conformance inspection shall consist of group A inspection, screening (when applicable), and group B inspection. Group B inspection shall be performed under periodic inspection.

4.6.1.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of all attenuators with the same PIN produced under essentially the same conditions, and offered for inspection at one time.

4.6.1.2 Screening. Screening shall consist of the examination and tests specified in table I in the order shown. Attenuators shall pass screening before being subjected to group A inspection.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.1.3 Group A inspection. Group A inspection shall consist of the examination and tests specified in table IV, in the order shown.

TABLE IV. Group A inspection. 1/

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Visual and mechanical examination	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, and 3.7	4.7.1
VSWR	3.5.3	4.7.4
Attenuation	3.5.4	4.7.5
Stability of attenuation: After peak power	3.5.10	4.7.11.7

1/ Post Burn-in (Screening) and Group A VSWR and Attenuation measurements may be performed concurrently.

4.6.1.4 Hundred-percent inspection. All screened attenuators shall be subjected to screening and group A inspection. All nonscreened attenuators shall be subjected to group A inspection. Defective units shall be individually rejected.

4.6.1.5 Rejected items. If an inspection item is rejected, the contractor may rework it to correct the defect and resubmit for reinspection. Such items shall be separate from new items and shall be clearly identified as reinspected items.

4.6.1.6 Test data. Data shall be taken and recorded for all tests performed on individual item and sent to the acquiring activity. The manner of performing measurements and data sheets shall be included and shipped in the same container as the attenuator. No classified information shall appear on the data sheet.

4.6.2 Periodic inspection. Periodic inspection shall consist of group B inspection. Except where the results of these inspections show noncompliance with the applicable requirements (see 4.6.2.5), delivery of products which have passed the screening and group A inspections (screened items only) or group A inspection (nonscreened items only) shall not be delayed pending the results of these periodic inspections.

4.6.2.1 Group B inspection. Group B inspection shall consist of the inspections, specified in table V, in the order shown. Prior to splitting test samples into groups, all four samples shall be tested at temperature extremes (see 3.1). The four sample units shall be divided into two groups of two units each. The units shall then be subjected only to the inspections indicated for their particular group. Group B inspection shall be made on sample units selected from inspection lots which have passed the group A inspection.

4.6.2.2 Sampling plan. Four sample units (see 4.5.2) shall be selected every 24 months. The first inspection shall be 24-months after the date of notification of qualification.

4.6.2.3 Failures. If one or more sample units fail to pass group B inspection, the sample shall be considered to have failed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.2.4 Disposition of sample units. Sample units which have been subjected to group B inspection shall not be delivered on contract.

4.6.2.5 Noncompliance. If a sample fails to pass group B inspection, the manufacturer shall notify the qualifying activity and cognizant inspection activity of such failure and shall take corrective action on the material or processes, or both, as warranted, and on all units of product which can be corrected and which were manufactured under essentially the same conditions, with essentially the same materials and processes, and which are considered subject to the same failure. Acceptance and shipment of the product shall be discontinued until corrective action, acceptable to the Government, has been taken. After the corrective action has been taken, group B inspection shall be repeated on additional sample units (all inspections, or the inspection which the original sample failed) at the option of the qualifying activity. Group A inspection may be reinstituted; however, final acceptance shall be withheld until the group B inspection has shown that corrective action was successful. In the event of failure after inspection, information concerning the failure and the corrective action taken shall be furnished to the cognizant inspection activity and to the qualifying activity.

TABLE V. Group B inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Group I - 2 sample units		
Stability of attenuation	3.5.10	4.7.11
After thermal shock		
After vibration		
After shock		
After moisture resistance		
After salt spray		
After peak power		
Sensitivity of attenuation	3.5.11	4.7.12
After change in frequency		
After change in input power		
After change in temperature		
Visual and mechanical examination	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, 3.7	4.7.1
Group II - 2 sample units		
Coaxial connector wear resistance: 1/	3.5.2	4.7.3
VSWR	3.5.3	4.7.4
Attenuation	3.5.4	4.7.5
Coaxial connector repeatability: 1/	3.5.6	4.7.7
Attenuation	3.5.4	4.7.5
Solderability 2/	3.5.7	4.7.8

See footnotes at end of table.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Group B inspection - Continued.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Group II - 2 sample units (Continued)		
Terminal strength/lead integrity 3/	3.5.8	4.7.9
Resistance to solvents 4/	3.5.9	4.7.10
Electromagnetic interference/RF leakage	3.5.5	4.7.6
Life: 760 hours Attenuation	3.5.12 3.5.4	4.7.13 4.7.5
Force to engage/disengage Attenuation	3.5.13 3.5.4	4.7.14 4.7.5
Coupling proof torque Attenuation	3.5.14 3.5.4	4.7.15 4.7.5
Visual and mechanical examination	3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, 3.7	4.7.1

1/ Coaxial types of attenuators.
2/ Attenuators with solderable leads or terminals.
3/ Attenuators with leads or terminals.
4/ Coaxial and waveguide type of attenuators.

4.7 Methods of examination and test.

4.7.1 Visual and mechanical examination (see 3.1, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6, and 3.7). Attenuators shall be examined to verify that the design, construction, physical dimensions, marking, and workmanship are in accordance with the applicable requirements.

4.7.2 Screening (see 3.5.1). Attenuators shall be screened as specified in 4.7.2.1 through 4.7.2.9.

4.7.2.1 Thermal shock. With the connections uncovered, attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 107 of MIL-STD-202. The following details and exceptions shall apply:

a. Mounting: When applicable, attenuators may be mounted on a heat sink.

b. Test condition: B, except the temperature extremes shall be those specified (see 3.1) and the number of cycles shall be ten (10). Place attenuators in the cold chamber for one-half hour. Attenuators shall be so positioned that they are exposed to freely circulating chamber air. Remove attenuators from the cold chamber and place in the hot chamber for one-half hour. Transfer shall take place within five (5) minutes of removal from the cold chamber, one cycle consisting of room temperature to cold, to room temperature to hot, and back to room temperature.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.2.2 Conditioning. Attenuators shall be conditioned as specified in 4.7.2.2.1 or 4.7.2.2.2.

4.7.2.2.1 Lossy attenuator element conditioning. Subject attenuators to a temperature of 100°C ±5°C for a period of 48 (+12, -0) hours.

4.7.2.2.2 Resistive film attenuator conditioning. Each end (input or output) of the attenuator shall be subjected to a direct current power level equal to the average power specified (see 3.1) at a temperature of +75°C ±5°C for a period of 48 ±3 hours (for a total of 96 hours). (Direct current power level is equal to the applied voltage times current). During the conditioning test, the attenuator shall be terminated in a 50-ohm resistive load.

4.7.2.3 Visual and mechanical examination. Visual and mechanical examination of attenuators shall be as specified in 4.7.1.

4.7.2.4 Pre-burn-in electrical. Before the burn-in is performed, the parameters listed in table I as pre-burn-in shall be measured at 25 (+0, -2)°C and the data recorded for all attenuators. Method of measurements shall be as specified in 4.7.2.4.1 through 4.7.2.4.3.

4.7.2.4.1 DC resistance. The DC resistance center conductor to center conductor and center conductor to case or ground (as applicable) for each side shall be measured using equipment capable of measuring one hundredth of an ohm.

4.7.2.4.2 VSWR. The VSWR shall be measured as specified in 4.7.4 at a low power level.

4.7.2.4.3 Attenuation. The attenuation (insertion loss) between ends shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5, with the exception that the signal source frequency shall be 100 Hertz (Hz).

4.7.2.5 Burn-in. Attenuators shall be burn-in tested for a minimum 120 hours for each end (for a total of 240 hours minimum) under the following conditions:

a. Temperature = 75°C ± 5°C.

b. Load = 50 or 72 ± 2 ohms (for coaxial and stripline attenuators)
= Nominal load (for waveguide attenuators).

c. DC power input = 0.5 Watt, + 50 mW, - 0 mW into one end for 120 hours minimum; apply this same power to the other end for the next 120 hours minimum.

4.7.2.6 Post burn-in electrical. After the burn-in, the same parameters specified in 4.7.2.4 shall be remeasured and the parametric change (delta) shall be determined. Attenuators that exceed one or more of the following delta limits shall be considered to have failed.

a. DC resistance - - - - - - ± 2 percent or 0.25 ohms, whichever is greater.

b. VSWR - - - - - - - - - - - ± 0.1.

c. Attenuation - - - - - - - - ± 0.05 dB for attenuators in the 0 dB to 9 dB range.
± 0.2 dB for 10 dB and higher value attenuators.

4.7.2.7 Radiographic. Attenuators shall be examined in accordance with method 209 of MIL-STD-202, the following details shall apply:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

a. A three-dimensional image quality indicator, constructed of, and containing materials which are compatible with the attenuators being X-rayed, shall be available for simultaneous exposure with the attenuator. The image quality indicator shall utilize slots, wires, and particles of sizes down to and including major dimensions equal to or less than 0.001 inch.

b. Two views shall be required, at 90° to each other, and both perpendicular to the major (long) axis of the attenuator.

c. The radiographs shall be examined under variable lighting conditions and magnification of 1X to 7X for the defects specified in paragraph 4 of MIL-STD-202, method 209.

d. The attenuators that have been X-rayed and found acceptable shall be identified with a blue dot. The blue dot shall be approximately .062 inch (1.57 mm) in diameter. The color selected from FED-STD-595 shall be any shade between 15102-15123 or 25102-25109. The dot shall be placed so that it is readily visible but shall not obliterate other attenuator markings.

e. Serialization of attenuators is required and must be correlatable to the film views. One film copy is required to be shipped with the attenuators. The manufacturer is not required to retain film copies. One copy of a report is required for each lot shipped indicating the number of attenuators radiographically inspected, the number found acceptable, and the number rejected.

4.7.3 Connector wear resistance (see 3.5.2). The connectors shall be subjected to 500 cycles of connection and disconnection. A cycle shall consist of a firm connection made to both connectors of the attenuator with the coupling means tightened to normal tightness and the connector then completely disconnected and removed from the circuit.

4.7.4 VSWR (at either end) (see 3.5.3). The VSWR of attenuators shall be measured at each end and at the specified frequency (see 3.1).

4.7.4.1 Procedure. VSWR of attenuators shall be measured using a system such as shown on figure 1 or equivalent. Tuners and pads shall be used, when necessary, to reduce residual VSWR of the system to a level that will assure accurate results before connecting the assembly under test. The overall accuracy of VSWR measurements shall be such that the absolute VSWR = (measured VSWR) +0.08 (maximum specified VSWR). VSWR (S11, S22) may be measured simultaneously with attenuation (S21), using an Automatic Network Analyzer. Multiple, accurate data points over the entire frequency range can be obtained with specified accuracy (see 3.1).

4.7.5 Attenuation (see 3.5.4). The attenuation of attenuators shall be measured. An Automatic Network Analyzer may be used. The attenuation (S21) and VSWR (S11, S22) can be measured simultaneously with multiple, accurate data points over the entire frequency range, with the accuracy therein specified over the frequency range specified (see 3.1).

4.7.6 Electromagnetic interference (when specified) (see 3.1) (RF leakage) (see 3.5.5). The swept frequency measurement shall be made covering the total frequency range in steps not exceeding an octave band (the appropriate stub antenna shall be tuned to a quarter wave at midoctave).

a. Place a fixed amount of RF power in a transmission line in series with a variable attenuator and spectrum analyzer.

b. Place specified value of attenuation (see 3.1) in the line and note the difference in readings on the spectrum analyzer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

c. Reset the attenuator to zero and place a λ/4 (at midband) at one end of the flexible coaxial cable and connected to the spectrum analyzer.

d. Place the test attenuator in a transmission line properly terminated and "SNIFF" the part with the λ/4 stub. The λ/4 stub shall come as close to the part as possible without touching. Particular attention shall be given to connectors, fastening devices, and flange interfaces.

e. Any attenuation in excess of the value specified in 4.7.6b shall be cause for rejecting the part.

4.7.7 Connector repeatability (see 3.5.6). Attenuators shall be tested for connector repeatability using a system as shown on figure 2. The following details shall apply:

a. Test at specified test frequencies or at three frequencies, one from each third of the rated frequency range.

b. Perform 10 complete connects and disconnects, both ends separately.

c. Rotate attenuator through full 360° with each mating at approximately 36° increments.

d. Cleaning of connectors or reshaping of contacts is not permitted during test sequence.

e. Side thrust shall not be permitted during test.

4.7.8 Solderability (see 3.5.7). The terminals of the attenuator shall be tested in accordance with method 208 of MIL-STD-202.

4.7.9 Terminal strength/lead integrity (see 3.5.8). Attenuators shall be tested as specified in 4.7.9.1 or 4.7.9.2.

4.7.9.1 Terminal strength. Attenuators with terminals shall be tested in accordance with method 211 of MIL-STD-202, test condition A, applied force 1.5 pounds.

4.7.9.2 Lead integrity. Attenuators with leads shall be tested in accordance with method 211 of MIL-STD-202, test condition C. The applied force shall be 8 ± 0.5 ounces. For leads with a section modulus equal to or less than that of a lead with a cross-section of 0.006 X 0.20, the force shall be 3 ± 0.3 ounces.

4.7.10 Resistance to solvents (see 3.5.9). Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 215 of MIL-STD-202. All portions of the attenuator shall be brushed.

4.7.11 Stability of attenuation (see 3.5.10). Attenuators shall be subjected to the tests as specified in 4.7.11.1 to 4.7.11.7 inclusive. At the conclusion of each of these tests, the attenuators shall be examined for evidence of mechanical damage.

4.7.11.1 With temperature change. The change in attenuation with temperature change shall be determined by measuring the attenuation of the attenuators (see 4.7.5 and figure 5) at 23°C ± 2°C with a maximum power input of 10 milliwatts (mW), and at both extremes of the operating temperature range specified (see 3.1). Source and load impedance as seen from the junction of both thermal isolators shall be reflectionless. When the dB is greater than 0.1 dB from reference to the extreme operating temperature, figure 5 is a recommended test setup.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.11.2 After thermal shock. Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 107 of MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

a. Test condition: B, -65°C to +100°C.

b. Measurements before and after thermal shock: Attenuation shall be measured (see 4.7.5 and figure 6), at the inspection conditions specified in 4.4, with minimum input power and at full-rated input power (see 3.1).

4.7.11.3 After vibration. Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 204 of MIL-STD-202. The following details and exceptions shall apply:

a. Test condition: D, unless otherwise specified (see 3.1).

b. Method of mounting: Attenuators shall be attached to the vibration table by clamps. Unless otherwise specified, a clamp shall be placed around the center of each attenuator, and no part of the attenuator shall touch any object other than the clamp.

c. Duration of vibration: One hour in each of three mutually perpendicular directions (total of three hours).

d. Measurements after shock: Attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5.

4.7.11.4 After shock. Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 213 of MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

a. Test condition: I, unless otherwise specified (see 3.1).

b. Measurement after shock: Attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5.

4.7.11.5 After moisture resistance. Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 106 of MIL-STD-202. The following details and exceptions shall apply:

a. Initial measurements: Not applicable.

b. Polarization and load: Not applicable.

c. Subcycle step 7b: Not applicable.

d. Final measurement: Attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5.

4.7.11.6 After salt spray. Attenuators shall be tested in accordance with method 101 of MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

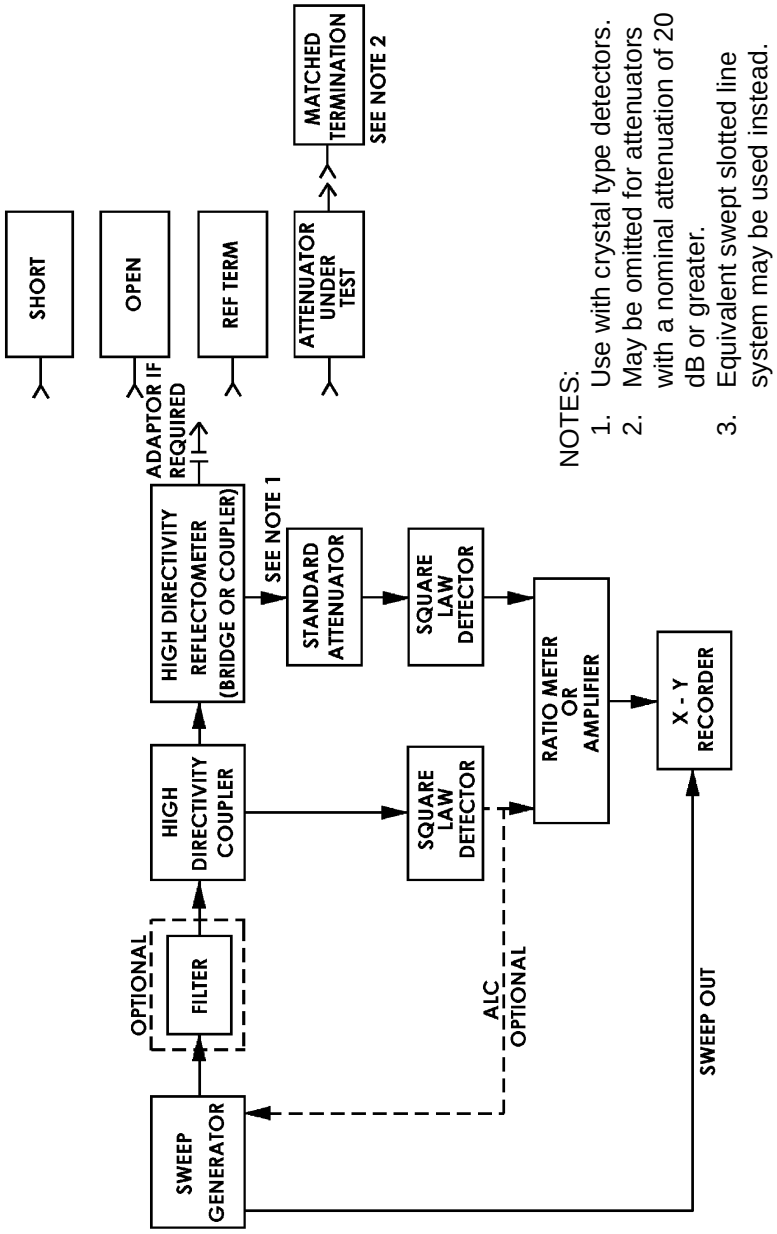
a. Special detail: During the test, connectors shall be mated to capped dummy connectors.

b. Test condition: B.

c. Examinations after exposure: Attenuators shall be examined for evidence of corrosion or pitting.

d. Measurements after salt spray: Attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5 after the attenuator has been cleaned of any salt accumulation.

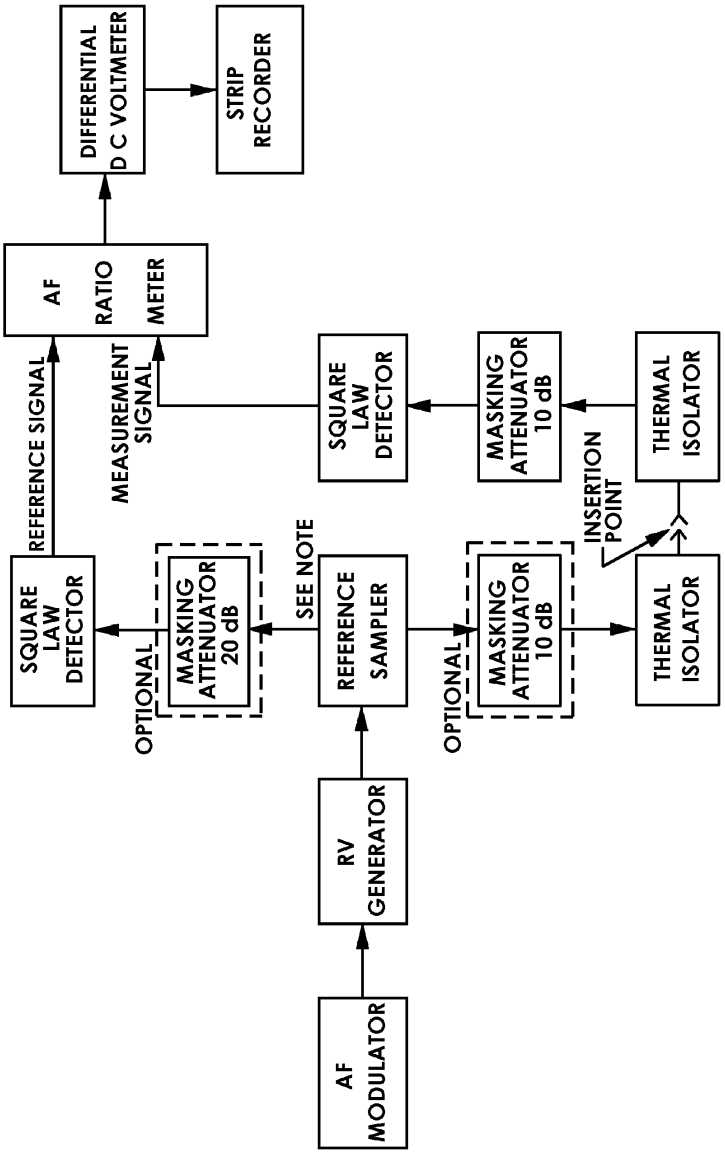
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:
1. Use with crystal type detectors.
2. May be omitted for attenuators with a nominal attenuation of 20 dB or greater.
3. Equivalent swept slotted line system may be used instead.

FIGURE 1. VSWR test setup.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTE: High directivity coupler or matched signal splitter.

FIGURE 2. Test setup for connector repeatability.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Accuracy for attenuation measurements.

Attenuation value, dB	Attenuator	Figure	Accuracy of attenuation measurements
Up to 50, incl.	Attenuators for use in general field equipment (specification sheets MIL-DTL-3933/10, /18 and /19).	3	Up to 10 dB, incl. - 0.2 dB Over 10 to 50 dB, incl. - 0.2 dB/10 dB
Up to 50, incl.	Attenuators for use in equipment in which precision and stability are secondary considerations (specification sheets MIL-DTL-3933/14, /16, /17 and /25).	4	Up to 10 dB, incl. - 0.5 dB Over 10 to 50 dB, Incl. - 0.5 dB/10 dB

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

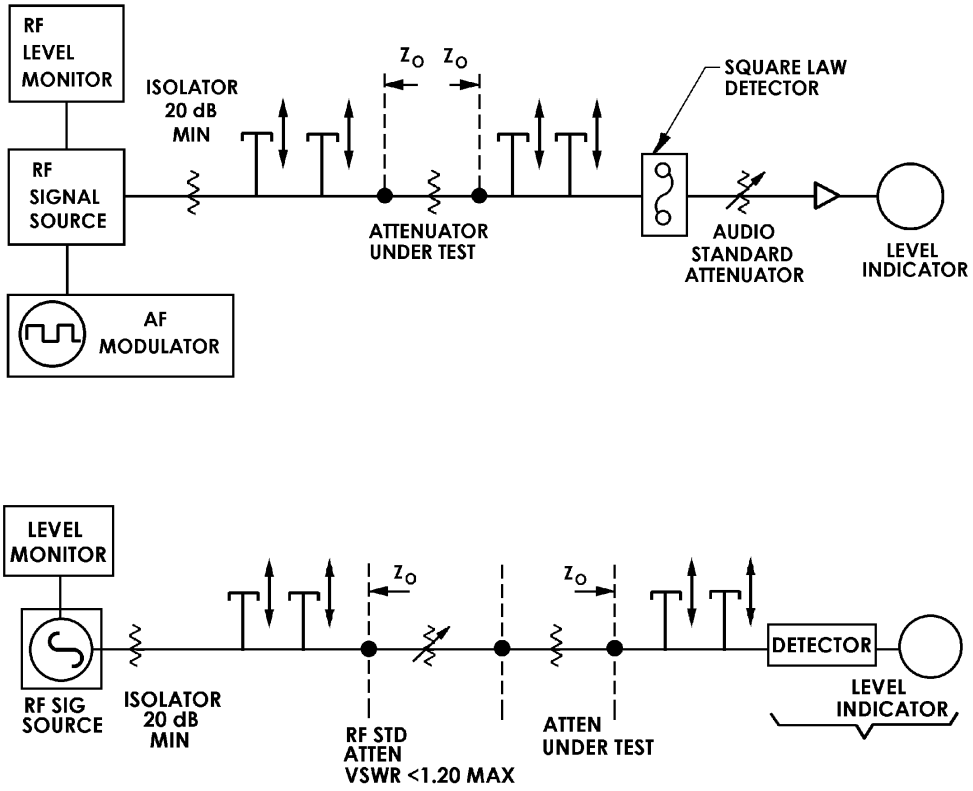


FIGURE 3. Test setup for attenuation measurements for attenuators up to 50 dB, incl., by RF-substitution method, or equivalent.

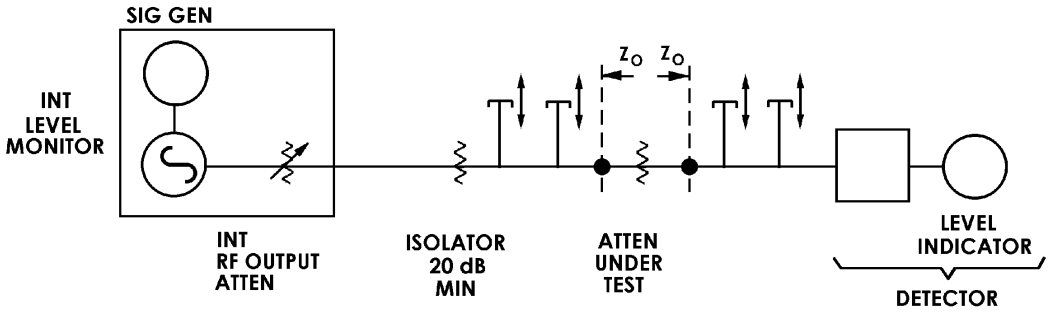


FIGURE 4. Test setup for attenuation measurements for attenuators up to 50 dB, incl., by signal-generator method, or equivalent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

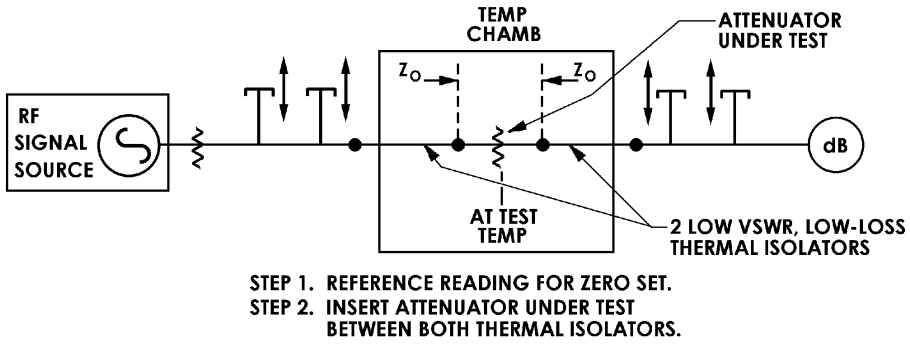


FIGURE 5. Modification of test setup for attenuation Measurement at extreme temperature.

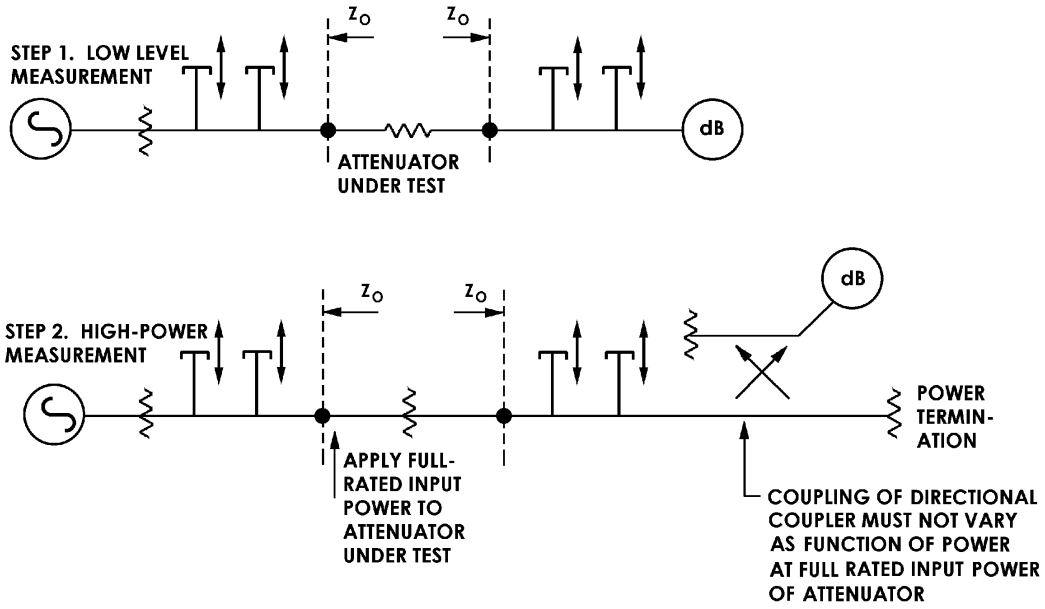


FIGURE 6. Modification of test setup for attenuation measurement at high power.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.11.7 After peak power. Attenuators shall be supported in still air and free space at the standard inspection conditions specified in 4.4. The specified peak power shall be applied for 1 hour at each end (see 3.1). After the attenuator has cooled to standard inspection conditions (see 4.4), attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.7.5.

4.7.12 Sensitivity of attenuation (see 3.5.11). Sensitivity of attenuation of attenuators shall be determined by measuring attenuation as specified in 4.7.5 at each extreme of the frequency range (see 3.1), at full input power (see 3.1) and any reference power, and at each extreme of the temperature range (see 3.1). Sensitivity of attenuation shall be computed in accordance with the following formulas:

$$\text{Frequency sensitivity} = \frac{\Delta dB}{dB}\frac{1}{\Delta f}$$

$$\text{Power sensitivity} = \frac{\Delta dB}{dB}\frac{1}{\Delta p}$$

$$\text{Temperature sensitivity} = \frac{\Delta dB}{dB}\frac{1}{\Delta t}$$

$$= \frac{\Delta dB}{\Delta t} \text{ for secondary standard over 20 dB}$$

Where:

ΔdB = Change in attenuation at either extreme of the operating frequency, at full input power, or at either extreme of the operating temperature (see 3.1).

dB = Attenuation at reference frequency, reference power, or reference temperature.

Δf = Change in frequency from reference to extreme, in GHz.

Δp = Change in power from reference to full input, in watts.

Δt = Change in temperature from reference to extreme, in °C.

4.7.13 Life. Attenuators shall be tested in the same manner as specified in 4.7.2.5 and 4.7.2.6, except the time shall be 380 hours for each end (for a total of 760 hours).

4.7.14 Force to engage/disengage. Attenuator connectors shall pass the force to engage/disengage requirements of MIL-PRF-39012.

4.7.15 Coupling proof torque. Attenuator connectors shall pass the coupling proof torque requirements of MIL-PRF-39012.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Attenuators covered by this specification are intended for use in the radio and microwave frequency region.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify:

6.2.1 For attenuators covered by specification sheets (see 3.1). Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of the specification.

b. Title, number, and date of the applicable specification sheet (see 3.1 and 6.6).

c. Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2.1).

d. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

e. If special or additional identification marking is required.

f. Magnesium alloy, only when specified (see 3.1).

g. PIN.

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Products List whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or purchase orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from Defense Supply Center Columbus, Code DSCC-VQE, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43216-5000.

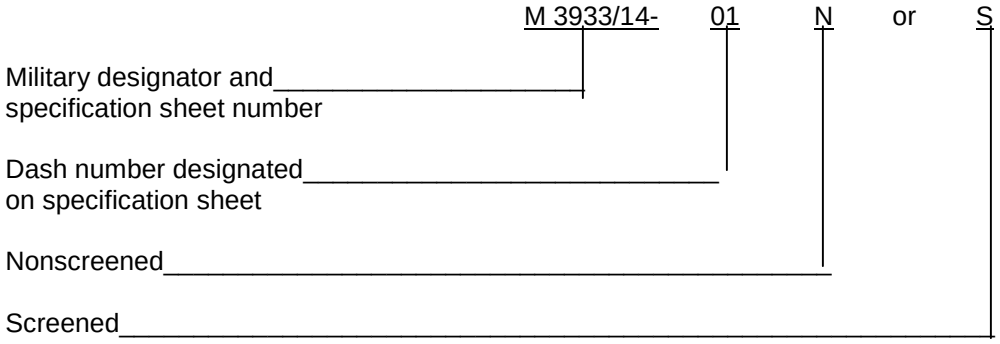
6.3.1 Copies of “Provisions Governing Qualification” SD-6 may be obtained upon application to Defense Automation and Production Service, Building 4D (DPM-DODSSP), 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6.4 Conditions for use of level B preservation. When level B preservation is specified, this degree of protection should be used for the acquisition of attenuators for resupply worldwide under known favorable handling, transportation, and storage conditions.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.6 Part or Identifying Number (PIN). The military PIN consists of the letter “M” followed by the basic number of the specification sheet, an assigned dash (see 3.1), and the letter N or S; where N indicates a nonscreened item and S indicates a screened item. PINs without an N or S are considered nonscreened items.



6.7 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Connectors	Lossy	Sensitivity
Electrical	Microwave	Stability
Flange	Qualification	VSWR
Interference, electromagnetic	Radio	Waveguide
Leads	Screening	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

APPENDIX

Group Qualification by Characteristics

10. SCOPE

10.1 Scope. Previous revisions of this specification appendix employed a “group qualification” approach that identified for all attenuator types, the entirety of ways in which each attenuator type could be qualified by previous qualification of other attenuators with more rigorous requirements characteristics. A simplified approach is adopted herein to enable the same matrix of group qualification possibilities, without reiterating the entire list of attenuator characteristics combinations available to accomplish group qualification. This appendix is a mandatory part of the specification and is intended for compliance.

20. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS (This is not applicable to this appendix.)

30. REQUIREMENTS

30.1 Group qualification. Group qualification is herein interpreted as “characteristic qualification”. Attenuators with subordinate characteristics, that have all been qualified by previous qualification of the same or more rigorous dominant characteristics in earlier qualified attenuators, are considered qualified, with no additional testing. Group qualification by characteristics requires previous qualification of dominant characteristics covering each subordinate characteristic listed in table AI. Qualification requires qualifying an attenuator characteristic listed under each characteristic category for an attenuator type. Acceptance of group qualification by characteristics is at the discretion of the qualifying activity (Defense Supply Center Columbus, Code DSCC-VQE, P. O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43216-5000.)

30.2 List of dominant attenuator qualification characteristics. The list of dominant attenuator qualification characteristics, listed by attenuator type, and associated lists of subordinate attenuator characteristics intended for group qualification by characteristics, is as follows:

TABLE AI. Characteristics for group qualification.

Attenuator type	Waveguide	
Characteristic category	Previous qualifying attenuator characteristic (dominant)	Attenuator characteristics (subordinate) qualified by group qualification
Screening	Screened Non-screened	Screened or non-screened Non-screened
Frequency range (GHz)	18-26.5 220-325	18-26.5 to 2.60-3.95 220-325 to 22-33
Average power	Low Low High Standard	Low to High 1/ Low to Medium 2/ High and Standard Standard
Attenuation	20 dB and 1 dB 40 dB 60 dB	20 dB to 0 dB 40 dB to 21 dB 60 dB to 41 dB

See footnotes at end of table.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

APPENDIX

TABLE AI. Characteristics for group qualification - Continued.

Attenuator type	Coaxial	
Characteristic category	Previous qualifying attenuator characteristic (dominant) values	Attenuator characteristics (subordinate) qualified by group qualification
Screening	Screened Non-screened	Screened or non-screened Non-screened
Frequency range (GHz)	DC-46 DC-26.5 DC-18 DC-12	DC-46, DC-26.5, DC-18, DC-12, DC-8, DC-2 DC-26.5, DC-18 DC-12, DC-8, DC-2 DC-18, DC-12, DC-8, DC-2 DC-12, DC-8, DC-2
Average power	Low Medium High	Low Medium High
Attenuation	20 dB and 1 dB 40 dB 60 dB	20 dB to 0 dB 40 dB to 21 dB 60 dB to 41 dB
Attenuator type	Stripline, Terminal, or Lead	
Characteristic category	Previous qualifying attenuator characteristic (dominant)	Attenuator characteristics (subordinate) qualified by group qualification
Screening	Screened Non-screened	Screened or non-screened Non-screened
Frequency range (GHz)	DC-12 DC-8 DC-4 DC-1	DC-12, DC-8, DC-4, DC-1 DC-8, DC-4, DC-1 DC-4, DC-1 DC-1
Average power	Low Medium	Low Medium
Attenuation	20 dB and 1 dB	20 dB to 1 dB

1/ For frequency range 18-26.5 GHz.
2/ For frequency range 220-325 GHz.

Custodians:
Army - CR
Navy - EC
Air Force - 11
DLA - CC

Review activities:
Army - MI
Navy - AS, MC, SH
Air Force - 71, 99
NASA - NA

Preparing activity:
DLA - CC

(Project 5985-1229)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.

2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7, and send to preparing activity.

3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER MIL-DTL-3933F	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 021107

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
ATTENUATORS, FIXED, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER		
a. NAME (Last, First, Middle initial)T	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2)DSN (if applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY		
a. NAME Defense Supply Center Columbus ATTN: DSCC-VAT	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial 614-692-0506	(2) DSN 850-0506
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) P. O. Box 3990 Columbus, OH 43216-5000	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Standardization Program Office (DLSC-LM) 8725 John J. Kingman Road, Suite 2533 Fort Belvoir, Virginia 22060-6221 Telephone (703) 767-6888 DSN 427-6888	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:28Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.